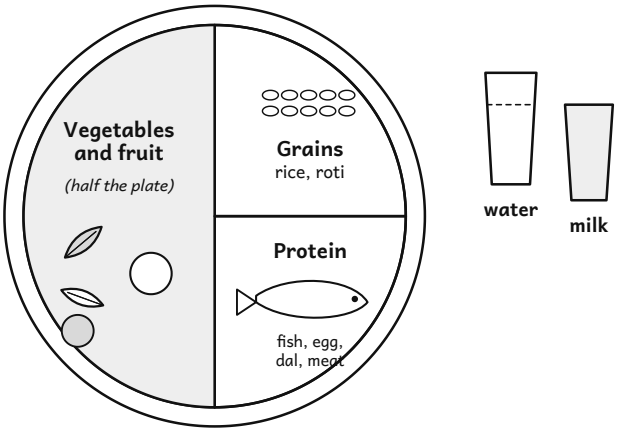
LIVING THINGS

Eating for Health

Nutrients, food groups, a balanced diet for Bangladesh and the choices we make



In this pack

- **Learn it:** A balanced diet for a healthy life ★☆☆
- **Fact check:** Food groups and nutrients ★☆☆
- **Think it through:** Is this meal balanced? ★★☆
- **Investigate:** How much sugar is in our drinks? ★★☆
- **Real-world case study:** From panta bhat to pizza: changing plates ★★★
- **Review and challenge:** Show what you know ★★★

This pack belongs to: _____ **Class:** _____

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A balanced diet for a healthy life

Name: Class: Date:

Learning goals

- Name the food groups and what each does for the body.
- Plan a balanced meal with foods in the right proportions.
- Discuss what affects the food choices people make.

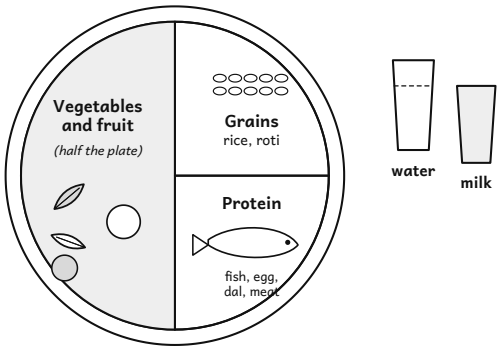
A plate of rice, dal, fish curry and vegetables. A packet of chips and a fizzy drink. Both fill your stomach, but only one gives your body what it needs. A **balanced diet** means eating a **variety** of foods, in the **right amounts**, so the body gets all the nutrients it needs.

The nutrients in food

Nutrient	What it does	Foods
carbohydrates	give energy	rice, roti, bread, potato, chira
proteins	growth and repair	fish, eggs, meat, dal (lentils), milk, beans
fats and oils	store energy, keep us warm	oil, ghee, butter, nuts (small amounts)
vitamins and minerals	keep the body healthy	fruit, vegetables, milk, small fish
fibre	helps food move through the gut	vegetables, fruit, whole grains, dal
water	needed by every cell	safe drinking water

Some minerals have special jobs: **calcium** (milk, small fish such as *mola*) builds strong bones and teeth; **iron** (leafy greens such as *lal shak*, meat, eggs) helps blood carry oxygen; **iodine** (iodised salt) helps the brain develop.

A healthy plate



A balanced meal: half vegetables and fruit, a quarter grains, a quarter protein.

Dietary guidelines for Bangladesh give similar advice: eat a **variety** of foods every day; do not fill the plate with rice alone; eat plenty of **vegetables and fruit**; include **fish, eggs, meat or dal**; drink **safe water**; use **iodised salt**; and limit salt, sugar, oil and fried snacks.

Moderation: not too much, not too little

Even healthy food can be eaten in the wrong amounts. Too little food can stop children growing properly. Too much food, especially sugary and fatty food, can lead to **obesity**, tooth decay and, later, diseases such as **diabetes** and heart disease.

What affects our food choices?

- **Cost:** fresh food can cost more than cheap snacks.
- **Availability and season:** mangoes in summer, winter vegetables in winter.
- **Culture and family:** *panta-ilish* at Pohela Boishakh, sweets and semai at Eid, pitha in winter.
- **Media and technology:** adverts, cartoons and food-delivery apps make fast food look exciting.

Things to avoid

Caffeine (in tea, coffee, cola and energy drinks) can stop children sleeping well. **Tobacco**, in cigarettes and in chewed forms such as *jorda* and *gul*, harms the mouth, lungs and heart and is very hard to stop using. **Alcohol and drugs** damage the brain and body and are especially harmful to children.

Did you know?

About 4 grams of sugar make one teaspoon. A 250 ml can of cola can contain more than 6 teaspoons of sugar.

Key words

balanced diet	a variety of foods in the right amounts
nutrient	a useful substance in food
carbohydrate	nutrient that gives energy
protein	nutrient for growth and repair
moderation	not too much and not too little
obesity	having too much body fat, which harms health
caffeine	a substance in tea, coffee and some drinks that keeps people awake

FACT CHECK · A4 · EATING FOR HEALTH

Food groups and nutrients

★☆☆ Grade 5

Name: Class: Date:

Learning goals

- Sort foods into groups.
- Match nutrients to their jobs.

1 Sort the foods into the main nutrient they give. [9]

SORT THESE

potato fish roti rice carrot spinach (palong shak) guava dal egg

Carbohydrates	Proteins	Vitamins and minerals

2 Match each nutrient to its job. [5]

Draw a line to match each pair, or write the letter.

carbohydrates ●	● **A** builds strong bones and teeth
proteins ●	● **B** helps blood carry oxygen
calcium ●	● **C** helps food move through the gut
iron ●	● **D** help us grow and repair
fibre ●	● **E** give us energy

3 Fill in the gaps. [4]

WORD BANK

variety iodised vegetables cola chips decay

A balanced diet has a _____ of foods in the right amounts. Half of a healthy plate should be _____ and fruit. Eating too much sugar can cause tooth _____. We should use _____ salt.

Is this meal balanced?

★★☆ Grade 5

Name: Class: Date:

Learning goals

- Evaluate meals.
- Plan a balanced day of meals.
- Explain factors that affect food choices.

1 **Look at these two lunches. Which is more balanced? Explain your answer.** [3]

Lunch A	Lunch B
a big plate of white rice, a little dal, a fried egg, a glass of cola	rice (one quarter of plate), mixed vegetables, fish curry, a banana, water

2 **Plan a balanced day of meals for a 10-year-old. Include a drink each time.** [4]

Meal	Foods and drink
Breakfast	
School tiffin	
Lunch	
Dinner	

3 **Why do some families buy more instant noodles and fewer vegetables? Give two reasons.** [2]

4 **Why should children not drink tea, coffee or energy drinks in the evening?** [2]

5 **Tobacco advertising is banned in Bangladesh. Why do you think the law does this?** [2]

INVESTIGATE · A4 · EATING FOR HEALTH

How much sugar is in our drinks?

★★☆ Grade 5

Name: Class: Date:

Learning goals

- Read information from food labels.
- Convert grams to teaspoons.
- Present and compare data.

Class 5D collected the nutrition labels from five drinks. They recorded the sugar in one 250 ml serving. (These are example values similar to real labels.)

1 **Convert the grams of sugar into teaspoons (4 g = 1 teaspoon). Round to the nearest whole teaspoon.** [5]

Drink (250 ml)	Sugar (g)	Teaspoons of sugar
cola	27	
mango juice drink	32	
energy drink	28	
plain milk	12	
water	0	

2 **Draw a bar chart of the grams of sugar in each drink.** [4]



3 **Health experts advise that children should have no more than about 6 teaspoons (24 g) of added sugar a day.** [3]

a) Which drinks contain more than this in one serving?

.....

b) Milk contains natural sugar but is still a good choice. Why?

.....

.....

4 **Write a conclusion and one piece of advice for your school.** [2]

.....

.....

.....

REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY · A4 · EATING FOR HEALTH

From panta bhat to pizza: changing plates

★★★ Grade 5

Name: **Class:** **Date:**

Learning goals

- Use evidence about how diets are changing.
- Weigh up cost, culture and health.
- Plan a healthy meal on a budget.

Science · Health · Maths · Culture · Economics

Fifty years ago most families in Bangladesh ate home-cooked food: rice, dal, fish and vegetables, with seasonal fruit. Many children in poor families did not get enough to eat, and many were too short for their age because of **undernutrition**.

Today the country grows much more food and fewer children are undernourished. But in towns and cities, more people buy **fast food**, fried snacks, sweets and sugary drinks, and many children spend hours on screens instead of playing outside. Doctors are seeing more children who are **overweight**, and more adults with **diabetes**.

Nutritionists say we can keep the best of both: traditional dishes such as shak, dal, small fish and seasonal fruit are cheap and very healthy, while fast food is fine as an occasional treat.

Based on reports on nutrition in Bangladesh (FAO, UNICEF, national nutrition surveys).

1 **What are the two different nutrition problems described in the text?** [2]

.....

.....

2 **Plan a healthy school tiffin that costs no more than 60 taka. Use the price list.** [4]

Food	Price (Tk)
banana	10
boiled egg	15
roti (2 pieces)	10
vegetable bhaji (small box)	20
guava	15
packet of chips	20
cola (250 ml)	35
bottle of water	15

My tiffin items	Cost (Tk)

3 **Explain why your tiffin is balanced.** [2]

.....

.....

4 **Different people have different views. What might each say?** [3]

Person	View on fast food
a fast-food shop owner	
a doctor	
a busy working parent	

5 **Suggest one change your school could make to help learners eat better.** [1]

.....

.....

Show what you know

★★★
Grade 5

Name: Class: Date:

Learning goals

- Use key vocabulary.
- Answer test-style questions.

1 **Find the key words.**

C	E	V	I	T	A	M	I	N	C	A
K	N	J	P	K	K	A	G	B	N	Y
D	E	A	R	I	R	O	N	E	I	R
I	R	L	O	F	B	P	R	M	P	W
S	G	F	T	I	A	W	W	U	S	Y
U	Y	I	E	I	L	T	Y	F	H	A
G	I	B	I	C	A	L	C	I	U	M
A	R	R	N	B	N	G	W	K	J	J
R	I	E	J	I	C	J	C	C	I	T
J	E	M	S	S	E	A	L	V	H	L
W	A	T	E	R	D	N	U	W	O	N

balanced **calcium** **energy** **fibre** **iron** **protein** **sugar** **vitamin** **water**

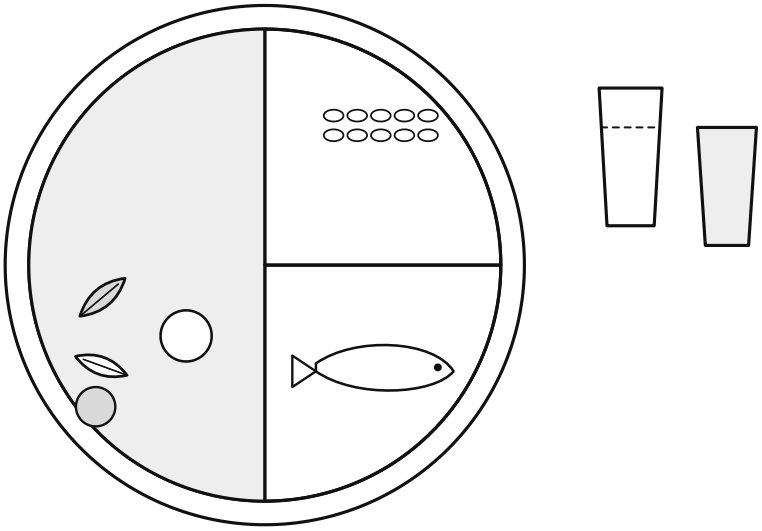
2 **Which food is the best source of protein?** [1]

- ◯ rice
- ◯ dal
- ◯ cola
- ◯ butter

3 **Which nutrient helps blood carry oxygen?** [1]

- ◯ iron
- ◯ fibre
- ◯ fat
- ◯ iodine

4 **Label each part of the healthy plate with a food group.** [3]



Part of the plate	Food group
the half on the left	
top right quarter	
bottom right quarter	

5 **Challenge. "Fat is bad for you, so we should never eat it." Do you agree? Explain.** [2]

.....

.....

.....

How am I doing? Colour or tick a circle.

I can...	Not yet	Nearly	Got it!
name the nutrients and what they do	○	○	○
sort foods into food groups	○	○	○
plan a balanced meal using a healthy plate	○	○	○
explain how cost, culture and media affect food choices	○	○	○
read a food label and compare sugar	○	○	○
explain why caffeine, tobacco, alcohol and drugs are harmful	○	○	○